

Field Crop Production

Science

May, 2026

Field Crop Production (A11494)

Short Title: Field Crop Production
Faculty Science and Computing
Department Science
Cluster Horticulture
Author CPWALSH
Credits 5

Level: Intermediate

Description of Module / Aims

The module will enable the student to plan and describe the production of a range of food crops at a large field scale and perform the associated skills to best industry practices.

Programmes

HORT-0028	BSc in Horticulture (WD_SHORT_D)	3 / 6 / E
HORT-0028	BSc in Horticulture (WD_SHORT_DX)	3 / 6 / E

Indicative Content

- Brassicas: Plan production and management schedules for all year round cabbage, sprouts, cauliflower and broccoli production
- Rootcrops: Plan production and management scheduled for vegetable root crops: carrots such as parsnips and swedes
- Potato production and storage
- Fruit: Apple production and storage. Extended season strawberry production
- Onion production and storage
- Evaluate the economics of mixed vegetables, potatoes and fruit
- Produce a plan for 25 ha of mixed vegetables

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:

1. Analyse the production of a range of vegetables including brassicas, rootcrops.
2. Analyse the production of potatoes.
3. Compare different production systems used for fruit crops such as apples, strawberries.
4. Plan a production programme for 25ha of mixed vegetables.
5. Appraise the economics of producing food crops.
6. Demonstrate skills associated with vegetable and fruit production employing proper health and safety practices.
7. Distinguish good environmental practices in food crop production.

Learning and Teaching Methods

- Lecture
- Practical demonstration
- Project
- Practice

Assessment Methods

	Weighing	Outcomes Assessed
Final Written Examination	50%	1, 2, 3, 5, 7
Continuous Assessment	50%	
<i>Practical</i>	25%	6
<i>Project</i>	25%	4

Assessment Criteria

<40%: Very little knowledge and understanding of the subject matter. Unable to carry out critical thinking or practical skills.

40%-49%: Demonstrates a limited knowledge of the subject matter. May have some problems with critical thinking and problem solving. Adequate practical skills.

50%-59%: Demonstrates satisfactory general knowledge of the main issues within the subject. Good practical skills.

60%-69%: Demonstrates skilled and sound knowledge of the subject matter. Shows ability to analyse and logically discuss in an effective way. Good critical thinking and a high level of competence and efficiency in theoretical and practical areas of this subject.

70%-100%: All of the above to an excellent level. Demonstrates authoritative handling of complex material and a highly developed and extensive understanding of the subject.

Note:

- In addition to the normal regulations, a minimum of 35% must be achieved in both the final exam and continuous assessment components of the module. In cases where continuous assessment has a practical component attendance of at least 75% in the practicals is mandatory.

Learning Modes

Learning Mode	F/T Hours	P/T Hours
Lecture	24	
Practical	24	
Independent Learning	87	

Supplementary Material

- Brewster, J.L. _Onions and other Vegetable Alliums, Volume 15 of Crop production science in horticulture_. Wallingford: CABI, 2008.
- Dixon, G.R. _Vegetable Brassicas and Related Crucifers, Volume 14 of Crop production science in horticulture_. Wallingford: CABI, 2007.
- Rubatzky, V., C. Quiros and P. Simon. _Carrots and Related Vegetable Umbelliferae_. Wallingford: CABI, 1999.

Requested Resources

- Lecture Room: Loose Seated